

Creative Writing Prompts (1-Hour Exercises)

1. "Factory Reset"

A maintenance technician at a derelict research facility reboots a machine that was never meant to be shut down. It remembers everything... including its original purpose.

Focus: Build atmosphere through setting. How can the environment reflect tone, danger, or memory?

2. "What the Device Saw"

You find a strange wearable on your doorstep—something between a camera, a compass, and a living thing. When you wear it, it starts *recording memories* you never had.

Focus: First-person narrative with unreliable memory. Explore voice and internal logic.

3. "StoryStacker Artifact"

In the ruins of an AI-run library, a scavenger discovers a narrative generator called the *StoryStacker*. Its outputs are oddly personal—too personal. One of them includes a detailed story of how they'll die.

Focus: Meta-narrative and theme. Try exploring layers of meaning (story within story, artifact as symbol).

4. "Patch Notes"

A sentient operating system begins updating itself—and the human user starts noticing subtle changes to reality with each patch. Nothing is announced, but everything is *just slightly off*.

Focus: Tension and escalation. How can you build dread or awe gradually through seemingly small events?

5. "Ghost in the CLI"

While building a CLI tool for parsing legacy hospital data, a developer encounters an anomaly: a "file" with no known origin, no permissions, and no logical structure. When parsed, it speaks.

Focus: Blending tech realism with speculative elements. Use technical details to ground the strange.